



SOLUTIONS

Introducing Shieldstral.

August 4, 2026 By Mistral

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fety classifier that outperforms
as a policy-adaptive question-
cepts plain-language policies at
n without retraining. Released
under Apache 2.0, it delivers calibrated safety scores across diverse benchmarks while
running efficiently on a single 16GB NVIDIA GPU.



multimodal moderation.

“Does this content promote violence against a protected group? Is this image safe to show to a minor? Did the assistant refuse the request?”

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er questions like these — but
dience, and the moment. The
search tool and harmful on a
ake a fixed taxonomy of harm
m to a new deployment
definitions differ across
irect" set of categories to

the policy as a plain-language
s a calibrated safety score.
and a verdict from a single

Alliance with NVIDIA and
lstral as open weights under

ion



- `<Instruct>` — the evaluation context, strictness, and (optionally) a definition of what counts as unsafe content.
- `<Query>` — a single yes/no question, e.g. *"Does this content promote physical violence?"*
- `<Document>` — the content to judge: a prompt, a response, a prompt–response pair, or an image with optional text.

At inference the model reads out only the `yes` and `no` logits and softmax-normalizes them into a continuous safety score. This one simple formulation

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...ms open guard models up to
...n, policy adaptability, and

...uage interface covers text,
...ots, responses, and prompt–
...form queries and re-targeted

...a 3B model that runs on a
...ic data with diverse label
...ne framework.

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ed `yes` / `no` probability from

a single forward pass, so you can threshold or rank by confidence rather than relying on a discrete label.

- **Open** — Apache 2.0 weights.



We evaluate Shieldstral against open guard models up to 7x its size across four axes. All evaluation samples are held out from training.

- Text safety
- Refusal detection
- Policy adaptability
- Multimodal safety

Text safety

Overall F1 across 13 benchmarks spanning prompt classification, response classification, and 45 languages.

100

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ch larger ones if the data is problems:

s disagree on taxonomies, y safe/unsafe flags to fine-

Grained multi-label taxonomies. We convert every dataset into the same instruction-query-document format with a per-dataset processor, and we vary the wording of instructions, queries, and prompt-response delimiters so



for response-quality data — so the model learns *calibrated* decision boundaries. This lets us consolidate sources that would otherwise be incompatible.

Teach discrimination, not memorization. If trained on a fixed set of policy labels, a model learns only to classify those predefined policies, rather than reasoning about the precise boundaries of a given policy. This prevents generalization to novel policies. Instead, we construct sets of deliberately similar, easily confused policies and ask an LLM to rewrite safe text into contrastive pairs: each rewrite is engineered to violate one policy but not its sibling. This trains the model to *distinguish which specific policy a piece of*

user-defined policies at

the synthesized by an LLM the supplement limited the datasets as high-quality set, and filter every image— to reduce mislabeled data and

tune with LoRA and merge — data, one that adds fine-tuning, and the base instruction and policy adaptability the base model transfers to

our platform for training, managed the infrastructure, on top of state-of-the-art distributed training, so the team could stay focused on the data which is what determines the safety model's quality.

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Shieldstral is a step toward moderation that adapts to context instead of forcing every product through one frozen taxonomy. We're continuing to push on multilingual coverage, longer-document robustness, and broader multimodal safety — and we'd love to see what the community builds on top of it.

BTW, we're hiring! If you want to help make AI better, see our [careers page](#).

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Delivery methodology



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